

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | SIEM | Splunk | Microsoft Sentinel | XDR

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniproper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Engineer with over five years of experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), and detection content development across large, complex enterprise environments. I have deep practical experience with Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detection engineering and threat hunting, alongside hands-on experience with Splunk and SPL for log analysis and use-case development. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I design, build, and maintain the SIEM and XDR capability protecting an 8,000-user organisation, encompassing data onboarding, integrations, detection content, automated response playbooks, and threat-led use case development. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and am experienced in delivering SIEM engineering capability within regulated, security-critical environments. I am fully eligible to work in the United Kingdom and hold a clean background suitable for security clearance processing.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (primary), Splunk/SPL, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, data source onboarding, log ingestion pipeline management, workspace administration
- **SIEM Engineering:** Detection content development, data connector configuration, integration design, threat-led use case authoring, alert tuning and fidelity improvement
- **XDR:** Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR), CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR/XDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), cross-platform correlation
- **SOAR / Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Logic Apps), CrowdStrike Falcon SOAR, PowerShell automation, API-based integrations, automated incident response workflows
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned use case development, Kusto Query Language (KQL), SPL, detection rule tuning, false-positive reduction, threat intelligence integration
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, cloud telemetry management
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, threat hunting, alert triage, escalation management, post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Scripting:** PowerShell (advanced), Python (working knowledge), REST API integrations
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 to Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Lead SIEM engineering for the organisation, managing Microsoft Sentinel as the primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, including data connector onboarding, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection content authoring, and integration with upstream and downstream security tooling
- Design and develop detection content across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, covering techniques across initial access, privilege escalation, lateral movement, and exfiltration
- Build and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and CrowdStrike Falcon SOAR, integrating with external APIs and security tools to automate containment, notification, and evidence collection workflows

- Manage the XDR capability across Microsoft 365 Defender, Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Defender for Identity (MDI), administering policies, triaging cross-product alerts, and correlating detections across identity, endpoint, and cloud workloads
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using Kusto Query Language (KQL) and Splunk Search Processing Language (SPL), analysing large volumes of telemetry from diverse log sources to surface hidden threats and indicators of compromise (IoCs)
- Manage data onboarding and integration across SIEM data sources including endpoint, cloud, identity, network, and email, ensuring comprehensive telemetry coverage and high-quality log ingestion
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) platform, engineering prevention policies, custom Indicators of Attack (IoA), and response workflows
- Manage vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), integrating vulnerability findings into SIEM risk context and prioritising by exploitability
- Lead incident response activities in accordance with the NIST 800-61 framework, managing incident timelines, containment, evidence preservation, and post-incident review to generate improvements to detection content
- Develop PowerShell scripts for SIEM automation, alert enrichment, data collection, and operational reporting pipelines

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2022 to March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Operated Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, developing and maintaining Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection queries, analytics rules, and threat hunting workbooks across endpoint, identity, and network log sources
- Used Splunk for supplementary log analysis and threat investigation, writing Search Processing Language (SPL) queries to interrogate historical and real-time event data
- Performed alert triage, investigation, and escalation across SIEM and XDR platforms including Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon, and Microsoft 365 Defender
- Built and tuned SOAR automation playbooks to standardise and accelerate response to high-volume alert types, reducing analyst mean time to respond
- Deployed and administered CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, configuring prevention policies and custom detection rules to improve endpoint threat detection coverage
- Managed Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and identity governance controls, supporting identity-based detections in the SIEM
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, correlating vulnerability data with SIEM threat context to prioritise response activities
- Contributed to detection use case development, mapping adversary techniques from MITRE ATT&CK to available telemetry sources and authoring new detection rules accordingly
- Supported security framework compliance activities aligned to ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), and Cyber Essentials Plus

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 to March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed endpoint security tooling and security policy enforcement across the SaaS platform infrastructure, maintaining system hardening and patch compliance
- Supported network security monitoring activities, access control configuration, and security log collection
- Contributed to Quality Management System (QMS) documentation and security framework alignment, supporting audit readiness
- Assisted with IT infrastructure build, patching, and vulnerability assessment activities to support a secure and compliant software delivery environment

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and built a threat-led detection content library in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), covering 40+ MITRE ATT&CK technique-aligned use cases across credential access, lateral movement, persistence, and exfiltration

- Engineered SOAR automation playbooks that reduced mean time to respond for common alert types including phishing, credential abuse, and endpoint compromise, by automating triage, containment, and notification steps
- Managed data onboarding and integration for 15+ log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, improving telemetry coverage and enabling cross-source correlation detections
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user estate, delivering a unified XDR capability with correlated alerts across endpoint, identity, and email workloads
- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM alongside Microsoft Sentinel, enabling cross-platform threat correlation and improving detection fidelity across endpoint and cloud data sources
- Developed PowerShell-based automation scripts that streamlined SIEM operational tasks including alert enrichment pipelines, automated log validation, and compliance reporting, significantly reducing manual engineer effort

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (UK)